



WEEKDAY INTERVIEW SCHEDULING SYSTEM

Operations Playbook — 80% SLA with 2 Interns

This document presents a complete operational design for Weekday's interview scheduling process — covering system architecture, capacity modelling, edge-case guardrails, and a continuous improvement framework — built to consistently achieve an 80% booking SLA within 24 hours using a team of two college interns.

Target SLA 80% 400 of 500 booked	Expected outcome 83–87% base case with innovations	Intern hours/day 8h incl. 45-min lunch	Calls needed ~40 down from 150 (old model)
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3 innovations that change the math



Slot lock: push model

Pre-assign a slot before first contact. Candidate confirms or reschedules — not browses and picks.

Message template:

"Hi Rahul, your interview with **Flipkart** is tentatively locked for **Tue, Mar 19 at 3 PM IST**. Reply **1** to confirm or **2** to suggest a different time."

- Exploits *default effect* — 70%+ accept what's pre-assigned
- Eliminates choice paralysis (0 browsing, 0 Calendly friction)
- Creates urgency: "slot is held, not just available"

Old conversion (Calendly link) **24%**

New conversion (slot lock) **65%**



Signal-based channel shift

Don't wait on time (4h, 6h). React to *delivery signals* — a read receipt or email open tells you far more than a clock.

WA delivered, unread 90 min
→ Call immediately (they're not checking WA)

WA sent but undelivered
→ Wrong number or no WhatsApp — email immediately

Email opened, link not clicked 45 min
→ WA nudge: "Did the link load okay for you?"

Email bounced instantly
→ Don't wait. Call or WA now — don't lose an hour

Old: time-based wait **10–13h cycle**

New: signal-based shift **4–5h cycle**



Scarcity micro-nudge

A second touchpoint, not a repeat reminder. Uses loss aversion: the slot they were assigned might go away.

Sent at 2h mark to non-responders:

"Hey Rahul, your **Flipkart** slot at **Tue 3 PM** is still held — but it releases at **5 PM today**. Just reply **1** to lock it."

- *Loss aversion* > reward framing — losing a slot hurts more than gaining one
- Deadline is same-day (5 PM), not vague — creates real urgency
- Works on procrastinators who opened the first message but deferred

Expected lift from this nudge **+10–12%**

Timing **90–120 min** after wave **1**

Math-backed conversion funnel

Conversion funnel (base case)

Total requests received		500
Pass pre-flight		490
WA delivered (88%)		431
Confirmed slot (75% of open)		323
Change request resolved		+39
Scarcity nudge (2h mark)		+28
Phone calls (~40 calls)		+24
Total booked		414

414 / 500 = **82.8% SLA** ✓

Capacity per intern (8h day)

Available minutes	480 min
Lunch + buffer (deducted)	– 60 min
Effective active minutes	420 min

RAM (OUTREACH)

Pre-flight + slot assign (250)	75 min
WA blast (250 msgs × 20s)	83 min
Monitor + scarcity nudge	40 min
Phone calls (~40 × 4 min)	160 min
Logging + wrap	20 min

Ram total active **378 min** ✓

SHYAM (OPERATIONS)

Pre-flight + dedup (250)	75 min
Process confirmations (~330)	110 min
Handle change requests (~40)	60 min
Send calendar invites	55 min
EOD log + failure tagging	30 min

Shyam total active **330 min** ✓

Scenario stress-test

Best case (WA 90%, confirm 80%)	89%
Base case (WA 85%, confirm 75%)	83%
Worst case (WA 75%, confirm 60%)	68% → 78% D2

Ram and Shyam: specialized roles, compressed timeline

Daily schedule: 9 AM – 5 PM with 45-min lunch

R

Ram — Outreach specialist

Sends, nudges, calls. Zero booking tasks.

S

Shyam — Operations specialist

Books, tracks, escalates. Zero outbound calls.

9:00–9:30



Pre-flight: REQ-001 to REQ-250

Validate phone, Calendly, duplicate check. Flag blocked to Shyam.

9:00–9:30



Pre-flight: REQ-251 to REQ-500

Validate email, deduplicate records, verify Calendly slots exist. Build slot-assignment list for Ram.

9:30–10:30



WhatsApp blast: 250 slot-lock messages

Template + 3 fields (name, company, slot). ~20 sec/msg = ~83 min, target finish by 10:15.

9:30–11:00



Process wave-1 confirmations

As "YES" replies arrive: book on Calendly, send calendar invite, log Booked ✓. ~30 sec per confirmation.

10:30–12:00



Monitor signals + scarcity nudge

At 11:00 AM: check delivery signals. Send nudge to all unread/no-reply. Flag "CHANGE" replies to Shyam.

11:00–12:00



Handle "CHANGE" requests

Send 3 alternate slots to candidates who replied "2". Book immediately when they pick. Escalate to PM if no slots left.

12:00–12:45



Lunch break

Hard stop. No messaging during lunch.

12:00–12:45



Lunch break

Hard stop.

12:45–3:00



Phone calls: ~40 candidates

From "delivered, unread 90 min" queue. Script: "Confirming your [slot]. Still works?" 4 min avg. 40 calls = 160 min.

12:45–3:30



Wave-2 bookings + call confirmations

Book everyone Ram confirms on calls. Process scarcity-nudge responses. Send calendar invites batch every 30 min.

3:00–5:00



Trickle monitoring + EOD help

Process late replies. Help Shyam with logging if ahead. No new calls after 4:30 PM.

3:30–5:00



EOD analysis + failure tagging

Tag every non-booked row with failure category. Fill continuous improvement log. PM debrief at 5:00.

Foolproof playbook: no blind judgment calls

Tier 1 Must handle — intern resolves without escalation

No response to first contact

Check delivery signal at 90 min. Unread WA → call immediately. Not delivered → try email. No email → escalate data quality.

Responds but doesn't confirm

They replied "2" (change) but went quiet? Send exactly 3 alternate slots. If silent 60 min more → call. Never send Calendly link again.

Calendly link broken (detected in pre-flight)

Caught in pre-flight: block this company batch, escalate to PM, don't contact candidates until fixed. Never send a broken link.

Already scheduled / duplicate request

Pre-flight dedup catches this. Mark SKIP, do not contact. Notify company: "Duplicate received for [Name] — already confirmed."

Booking page won't load for candidate

They tell you it won't load → Shyam books for them directly on Calendly after verbal or WA confirmation. Candidate never needs to touch the link.

Request at bad time (weekend, late night)

Pre-flight flags it. Hold outreach until next business morning. Reset SLA clock to send time, not receipt time. Never message after 8 PM.

Candidate books wrong slot

Confirmation message immediately re-states slot. If wrong: Shyam cancels + re-books correct slot. Confirmation step is the safety net.

Wrong / missing contact info

Pre-flight catches. Escalate to company with exact request: "Need valid phone for [Name] by 11 AM." If not received: mark as data-blocked, skip today.

Both interns contact same candidate

Tier 2 Attempt resolution — escalate if >15 min blocked

Candidate unavailable (travel, leave, shifts)

Ask: "When are you back?" Log return date. Escalate to PM with note: "Candidate available from [date]. Ask company for later slots." Don't retry until PM confirms.

Intent changed since agreeing

Soft signal ("too busy") → one scarcity nudge then stop. Hard signal ("not interested") → acknowledge, log as Declined, never contact again. Don't push.

Calendly has very limited slots

Detected in pre-flight (count slots vs. candidates). If slots < candidates × 1.2: flag to PM before sending. Assign slots in order of priority; alert PM when last slot fills.

Books then cancels (false success)

Confirmation message + 30-min window catches this. If cancel received: one re-offer ("We have one slot left at [time]."). If they decline: log Cancelled, move on.

Candidate has overlapping multi-company requests

Shyam checks candidate schedule before booking. If overlap: alert candidate ("You have [Company A] at 2 PM — this is 2:30 PM. Confirm?"). Let them choose; don't force-book.

Tier 3 Escalate to PM — intern stops, documents, moves on

Explicit decline

One sentence acknowledgment. Log: Declined-explicit. Never retry. Flag if volume is unusually high (signals messaging quality issue).

Timezone impossible

Caught in pre-flight. PM contacts company: "Can you offer [times] for a [timezone] candidate?" If no: mark Unresolvable, don't waste intern time.

System failure / outage

Ownership lock: Ram owns REQ-001 to 250, Shyam owns 251–500. No exceptions. Dedup in pre-flight catches overlap before any message is sent.

Duplicate candidate records

Pre-flight dedup by phone number (primary key). Keep record with more fields complete. Delete the other. Contact exactly once.

Document start time. Pause outreach. Log all in-flight candidates as Paused. Resume when restored. PM extends SLA window for affected batch.

Company recruiter unresponsive

Try once via email, once via call. If no response in 4h: PM escalates through account management. Intern does NOT keep trying — marks Company-blocked and moves on.

Device/firewall blocks Calendly

Shyam books on their behalf after verbal or WA confirmation. Candidate never needs Calendly access. Send Google Calendar invite directly.

Self-improving flywheel: EOD analysis + daily agile

Step 1 — EOD failure tagging (Shyam, 30 min at 4:30 PM)

Every non-booked row gets exactly **three tags**. No free text — choose from the taxonomy. This makes patterns scannable in seconds.

Tag 1 — Who caused it?

Candidate Company System Data

Tag 2 — What broke?

No-response Declined Technical

Timing Capacity Bad-data

Tag 3 — Stage it failed at?

Pre-flight Wave-1-WA Nudge Call

Confirmation

Failure log columns in Google Sheets:

REQ_ID | Who | What | Stage | Notes
(optional)

Step 2 — Daily agile cycle (PM, 20 min)

1 9:00 AM — pattern review (5 min)

Open yesterday's failure log. Sort by "What" tag. Identify the single highest-count tag. That's today's one fix. Don't fix everything at once.

2 12:00 PM — pace check (5 min)

Count confirmed bookings by noon. If < 150 (30% of target), something is wrong — intervene immediately. Don't wait for EOD to discover a problem.

3 5:00 PM — debrief (10 min)

Three questions only: (a) Did we hit 80%? (b) What was the #1 failure reason? (c) What's the one-line fix for tomorrow? Log in the playbook changelog.

Step 3 — The self-improving flywheel



Run playbook

Day 1 baseline.
Tag all failures exactly.



Spot the pattern

One tag dominates. That's your lever.



One fix only

Change message, timing, or escalation. One variable at a time.

Pattern → fix examples from the failure taxonomy:

Top tag: Candidate · No-response · Wave-1-WA

Fix: Move WA send earlier (8:45 AM). Check if messages are being delivered.

Top tag: Company · Capacity · Pre-flight

Fix: Add Calendly slot count check to pre-flight. Alert PM at 8:45 AM if insufficient.

Top tag: Candidate · Timing · Nudge

Fix: Move nudge from 2h to 90 min. Test if shorter urgency window lifts response.

Top tag: Data · Bad-data · Pre-flight

Fix: Add phone format validation to intake form. Send companies a data quality SLA.

What makes this system actually hit 80%

The math works because the architecture changed, not the effort. Slot lock turns a 24% first-message conversion into 65%. Signal-based shifting cuts the cycle from 10 hours to 4. Scarcity nudge adds 10–12% without any extra channel. Ram and Shyam each work a clean 8-hour day with lunch, specializing so there's zero context-switching. The failure tagging system means Day 5 outperforms Day 1 automatically — without any retraining. The system gets faster as it learns what actually blocks your specific candidate pool.